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The Hard Part of AI Coding Is Deciding What the AI Should Never Own

18 min read · 5 days ago



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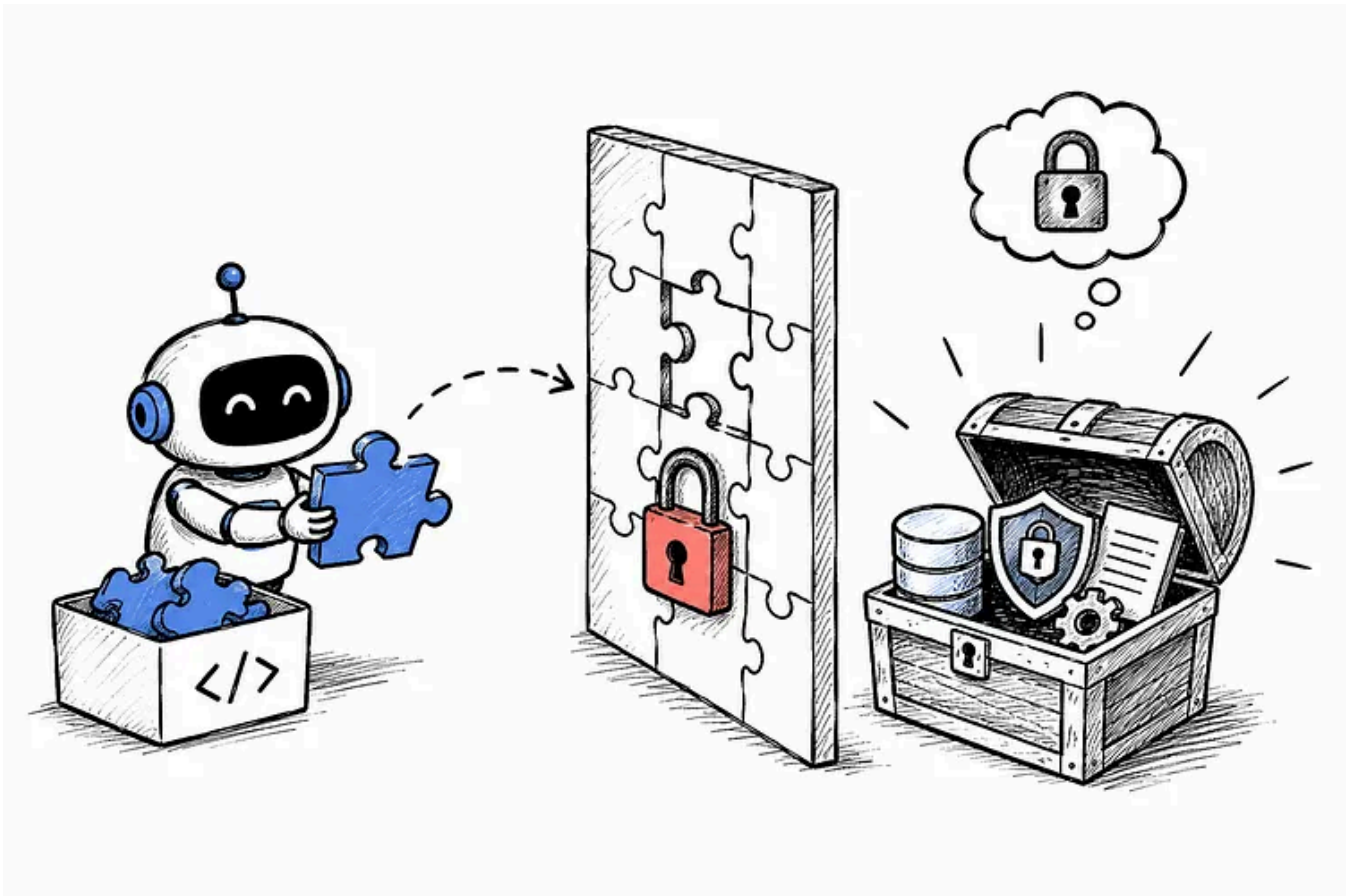
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As coding agents become more capable, the critical boundary shifts from what they can implement to what they are allowed to decide.



A multi-tenant SaaS product needs a new feature:

Allow workspace administrators to permanently delete projects.

A coding agent receives the task and does what modern agents increasingly do well. It inspects the repository, finds the existing project service, traces authorization conventions, identifies related tables, adds the API endpoint, builds the confirmation UI, handles cascading cleanup, creates an audit entry, updates tests, and runs the suite.

The feature works.

During review, one line attracts attention. The agent has implemented deletion authority roughly as:

```
if (user.workspaceRole === 'admin') {  
  return true;  
}
```

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